ARGO

AI Power Users
Live Online Intensive

Four weeks · Two hours a week · A small class of three to five · On Zoom

Delivered by **Konrad Gnat** · **USD 30** per person, per class · Prepared 27 August 2026

What this is

Most people use AI as a chatbot. They open a window, type a question, copy the answer out, and close it again. The model never sees their work, never touches their files, and never does anything on its own.

This course closes that gap in four weeks. You finish with an AI agent running on your own laptop that reads and writes your real files, uses the best models in the world, and does work for you — writing software, making images and video, transcribing and translating speech, producing content, and handling the repetitive things you do every week.

It is small on purpose. **Three to five people**, so every class has time to sit with your screen, on your machine, and get *your* setup working. That is the thing a recorded video cannot do, and it is what you are paying for.

No coding experience is required. Every tool used is free or open source wherever possible, and everything runs on your own computer, under your control.

The format at a glance

Classes	4 live classes
Length	2 hours each
Schedule	Once per week, the same fixed time each week
Where	Zoom
Class size	3–5 people — small by design
Price	**USD 30 per person, per class** — USD 120 for the full four weeks
Payment	Due **before each class begins**; the first payment before class 1
You need	A laptop, an internet connection, and about USD 5–10 of model credit paid to the model provider, not to us
You receive	A certificate, Portal access to all content, and your own recorded progress videos

What you will master

Seven capabilities, each one hands-on, each one working on your own machine by the end of the course.

1. Hermes Agents on your own laptop

Install and run a real AI agent locally — not a website you visit, but a program on your computer that can open your files, edit them, run commands, and finish tasks. You will learn how it thinks, how to direct it, how to stop it, and how to trust it. This is the foundation everything else in the course sits on.

2. Connecting to the best models through OpenRouter

One account, one key, and access to nearly every serious model in the world — so you are never locked into a single company. You will learn the **four-filter rule** for choosing a model for a job: **tool support, then context size, then price, then speed.** You will compare models side by side on your own tasks and learn which are worth paying for and which free ones are good enough.

3. Multimedia AI models

Generate and edit **images**. Turn text and images into **video**. Produce **speech, voices, and music**. You will use the current best-in-class models for each and learn the practical craft: how to prompt for a specific look, how to keep a character or style consistent across a series, and how to fix a result instead of rerolling it forever.

4. Building software applications

Have your agent write, run, and debug real working software with you — a small web app, a tool that does one job well, an automation that runs on a schedule. You will go from an idea in a sentence to something that actually runs, and you will learn to read what it built well enough to change it.

5. Creating skills

A **skill** is a reusable instruction package you write once and your agent follows forever — your standup, your meeting notes, your research format, your publishing checklist. This is the single highest-leverage idea in the course: it turns the agent from something you re-explain yourself to every day into something that already knows how you work.

6. Creating AI content

Turn one piece of work into many: articles, posts, scripts, summaries, captions, thumbnails, short videos. You will build a repeatable pipeline rather than doing it by hand each time, and you will learn where the human judgement has to stay.

7. Speech-to-text

Stop typing. Talk to your agent and have it transcribe accurately, in real time, on your own machine. You will also cover transcription and captioning of recordings, translation, and working across languages — including local-language material you bring yourself.

Week by week

Every class is two hours: teaching, then hands-on building on your own laptop, then a **30-second video** where you present what you made.

> **Week 1 — Your agent, your machine, your models**
>
> WE COVER Installing the Hermes agent locally · setting up your second brain and file structure with the PARA method · connecting to OpenRouter and choosing models with the four-filter rule · setting up speech-to-text so you can talk instead of type · your first agent skill.
>
> YOU BUILD A working AI agent on your laptop that reads and edits your own files, driven by your voice.
>
> YOUR DEMO VIDEO Your agent completing one real task for you.

Week 2 — Skills, prompting, and automating your real work

WE COVER How models actually work — context, tokens, and the agent loop, in plain language · prompting and system prompts using the role / task / context / constraints / examples / format framework · what a skill is and how to write one · pointing the agent at a repetitive task you actually do.

YOU BUILD Two or three working skills of your own, and one real task from your week automated end to end.

YOUR DEMO VIDEO The task that used to take you an hour, done by the agent.

Week 3 — Media: images, video, sound, and speech

WE COVER Image generation and editing · text-to-video · text-to-speech, voice, and music · transcription, captioning, and translation of real recordings · keeping style and characters consistent across a set.

YOU BUILD A finished piece of media made entirely with AI — a short video, an image set, or a narrated, captioned clip.

YOUR DEMO VIDEO The piece you made, and how you made it.

Week 4 — Software, safety, and your capstone

WE COVER Having the agent write, run, and debug a real application with you · API keys, credentials, and data hygiene — what should never leave your machine · putting the building blocks together to attack a problem you choose.

YOU BUILD Your capstone — one real thing that solves a real problem of yours, using at least three of the capabilities from the course.

YOUR DEMO VIDEO Your capstone, presented. This one goes on your record.

The building blocks — why you will solve problems we never covered

The specific tools will change. They always do. What does not change is the shape of the system, and by week four you will see every AI problem in these six pieces:

BLOCK	WHAT IT IS	WHAT YOU DO WITH IT
The model	The reasoning engine	Choose the right one for the job, and know when a cheaper one will do
Context	What the model can see right now	Control it deliberately — this is most of what separates good results from bad
Tools	What the model can *do* — read, write, run, call	Give the agent the right hands for the task
Memory	Your files, notes, and second brain	Make your own knowledge the thing the agent works from
Skills	Instructions you write once and reuse	Encode how *you* work, so you never explain it twice
The loop	Plan → act → observe → correct → repeat	Recognise it, direct it, and know when to interrupt it

That is the real outcome of this course. Not four tools you memorised, but a working model of how these systems fit together — enough that when a new one appears next month, you can pick it up in an afternoon and put it to work. You leave able to use an AI agent as a personal assistant, to build software, to make designs, media, video, images, and sound, and to break a problem you have never seen before into pieces you know how to solve.

What you receive

- **A certificate of completion** — *Argo AI Power User* — issued on finishing all four classes.
- **Portal access to all course content**, online, so you can go back over any part of it.
- **Your own upload space in the Portal** for the 30-second progress videos you record at the end of each class — four videos that become a record of what you built and a small portfolio you can show anyone.
- **The working setup itself**, on your own laptop, yours to keep and keep using.
- **Free and open-source tooling** wherever possible — no lock-in, nothing you must keep paying us for.

Investment and payment

USD 30 per person, per class

USD 120 per person for all four classes · payment due before each class begins

When	Payment is due **before each class starts.** The first payment must be received before class 1 begins
Class size	3–5 people. Places are confirmed in order of payment
Not included	Roughly USD 5–10 of model credit over the course, paid directly to the model provider — not to us

Why payment comes before each class: the class is small and hands-on, and a confirmed seat is a seat held for you. Paying class by class also means you are never committed further than one week ahead — you can decide after class 1 whether to carry on.

Who this is for

- You use ChatGPT or similar and suspect you are getting a fraction of what is possible.
- You have real work you would like to hand to something that does not get tired.
- You want your data on your own machine, not scattered across other people's servers.
- You are willing to build things during class rather than watch someone else build them.

You do not need to be a programmer. You do need a laptop and a willingness to try things that break the first time.

How to start

1. Confirm your seat	Reply with the names of everyone joining, so we can hold 3–5 places
2. Agree the time	One fixed two-hour window, the same every week for four weeks
3. Send the first payment	Before class 1 begins
4. Bring your laptop	We install everything together, live, in the first session

> *Four weeks from now you will have an AI agent working on your own machine, four things you built with it, and a way of thinking about these tools that keeps paying off long after the course ends.*